

Youtube, Google Duo, Docs, Calendar, cloud storage facilities, Google Pixel (the smartphone), etc., are just some of the examples of Google's services and products, most of which have quietly made a place for themselves in our daily lives without us even realising it.

For instance, this article is being pieced together in Google Docs, will be shared through Google mail (Gmail), and research for it was done using the Google search engine. It's like *Inception* in a way, where we're using Google to read and write about Google!

Features

The reason why Google holds about 77 per cent of the global search engine market is its search results, which are carefully curated, depending on the ranking of a page and also, analyzing user search behaviour over time. Google search results come with a two line description or summary and a preview. The search engine's unique algorithm, as complicated as it may be, has brought about an unparalleled efficiency in the market. It has given rise to the concept of search engine optimization, whereby websites try and increase their Google Ranking (in order to appear towards the top of the search results). This is done in order to increase the traffic that comes to the sites, because as we all know, the real currency has always been users and eyeballs. An entire industry has developed around search engine optimization, and although the focus is not limited to Google search only, it's the most important search engine of them all. Google, in turn, helps websites understand how to increase search engine rankings, without giving away any details about how the algorithms work, and this in turn, usually, results in a more reader friendly web for everyone.

PageRank

Google's success with its search engine is largely attributed to its algorithm PageRank, which decides how relevant a page is, by studying the pattern formed by hyperlinks. Founder Larry Page's original method was to look at the outside links pointing to a page and also the embedded links on it, and then through complex math, it all came together to give a page a score for a given search term, and this yielded more accurate results.

For example, you obviously cannot read a book in order to know whether you should read it! What you can do, however, is not judge a book by its cover (keywords, as old search engines did), and instead decide its relevance